

A Prayer for Sleepless Nights

Scripture & a Prayer for When You Cannot Rest

Psalm 127:2 (KJV)

“It is vain for you to rise up early, to sit up late, to eat the bread of sorrows: for so he giveth his beloved sleep.”

Psalm 121:3–4 (KJV)

“He will not suffer thy foot to be moved: he that keepeth thee will not slumber. Behold, he that keepeth Israel shall neither slumber nor sleep.”

Proverbs 3:24 (KJV)

“When thou liest down, thou shalt not be afraid: yea, thou shalt lie down, and thy sleep shall be sweet.”

Psalm 91:5 (KJV)

“Thou shalt not be afraid for the terror by night; nor for the arrow that flieth by day.”

A Prayer

Father, it is late, and I am still awake. The house is quiet, but my mind is not — it keeps replaying today and rehearsing tomorrow, turning over worries I cannot solve at this hour. You see every thought I cannot switch off.

Thank you that you never sleep, and that nothing I am afraid of has slipped past you. While I lie here, you are already watching over the people I love and the things I cannot control. I do not have to keep watch tonight, because you never stop watching.

Quiet my racing thoughts and loosen the grip of every fear. Help me to hand you the day that is ending and the one that is coming, and to leave them both in your hands until morning. Remind me that rest is your gift, not something I have to earn.

Steady my breathing, soften my body, and let your peace settle over this room. Even now, give me the sweet sleep you promise to those you love.

Amen.